
5. Chronological Travel Narrative

Day by day, 1-5 September 2026

Along the Chambal: From Kota's Palace to Pratihara Temples

Five days, one river, two states. The Chambal built these places, powered the dams, and marked the line between Rajasthan and Madhya Pradesh.

Day 1 - 1 September

Kolkata → on the rails

We left Kolkata on the Howrah Rajdhani Express at 16:50, the first evening of the trip, with the Chambal still two days away.

Day 2 - 2 September

New Delhi → Kota

The Rajdhani reached New Delhi at 10:05. After a few hours' wait we boarded the Kerala Sampark Kranti Express at 13:10 and headed south-west into Rajasthan.

We arrived in Kota at about 18:05 and checked in at Hotel Chandan. The evening belonged to the riverside, our first look at the Chambal.

Day 3 - 3 September

Kota → Rawatbhata

The morning began at the Kota Museum, then Kota Fort, the starred highlight of the plan, with its elephant gate and mirrorwork.

We drove out to Gepernath, but monsoon restrictions meant we couldn't get close to the shrine.

We then moved to Rawatbhata for the Baroli temples and the Rana Pratap Sagar Dam, and stayed the night there.

Day 4 - 4 September

Rawatbhata → Bhanpura

After checking out at about 13:00, we visited Chuliya and Padajhar falls, then Gandhi Sagar Dam, and by mid-afternoon Chambal Sunset Point.

Our last stop of the day was the Dharmrajeshwar rock-cut temple at Chandwasa. We stayed at Hotel Rudraksh in Bhanpura.

Day 5 - 5 September

Bhanpura → Jhalwarpatan

After checking out, we visited the Holkar Chhatri and Bade Mahadev in Bhanpura, then the lakeshore known as "Mini Goa".

Our last historic stop was the Kakuni temple complex. We reached Jhalwarpatan in the evening and checked in at Jhalwar Hotel, where the plan ends.

Closing

In five days we went from a Rajput fort and Pratihara temples to modern dams, a temple carved down into rock, and a Maratha memorial. The Chambal connected all of it. The plan ends at the Jhalwarpatan check-in; its temple town and the water fortress of Gagron wait for the next journey.